Berlin 2026 — locked metrics summary

Shared numbers for `civic-tech-evaluation.md`, `portfolio-case-study.md`, and the public story `public-project-story.md`.
Exports analysed: `stats/` (snapshot dated 14 Oct 2026). **End of elections: 20 Sep 2026, 18:00 Europe/Berlin**.

Charts: regenerate with `python3 scripts/generate-report-charts.py` → `charts/`.

Instrumentation timeline

Layer	Coverage in exports	Role
Vercel Web Analytics	14 Jul – 14 Oct 2026	Lifetime **reach** (visitors, pages, referrers, devices). Visits began before advanced product analytics.
Google / Bing Search	~3 Sep – 11 Oct 2026 (charts); keyword aggregates	Discovery / search interest
PostHog (product events, cookieless)	**15 Sep 22:20** – **14 Oct 01:26** Europe/Berlin	**Engagement detail** added when capacity allowed: pageviews, `topic_open`, `party_toggle`, `party_preset`, `program_link`, `ui_language`

PostHog's first product events are **not** site launch — visits already existed on Vercel. Topic/party interest data is an **additional benefit** from later instrumentation, not something that was missing from the original plan. Topic-level detail before ~15 Sep is simply out of scope for that layer.

Time windows

Window	Definition	What can be split
Before end of elections	Activity ≤ **2026-09-20 18:00** Europe/Berlin	PostHog events only (instrumented from ~15 Sep)
After end of elections	After poll close → end of exports (~13–14 Oct)	PostHog events (continued use was unexpected; team had assumed demand would stop at election end)
All-period	Full Vercel / SEO export ranges	Vercel + Search Console / Bing aggregates (not 18:00-splitable in current CSVs)

Label the PostHog "before" window as **instrumented before end of elections**, not "full campaign engagement."

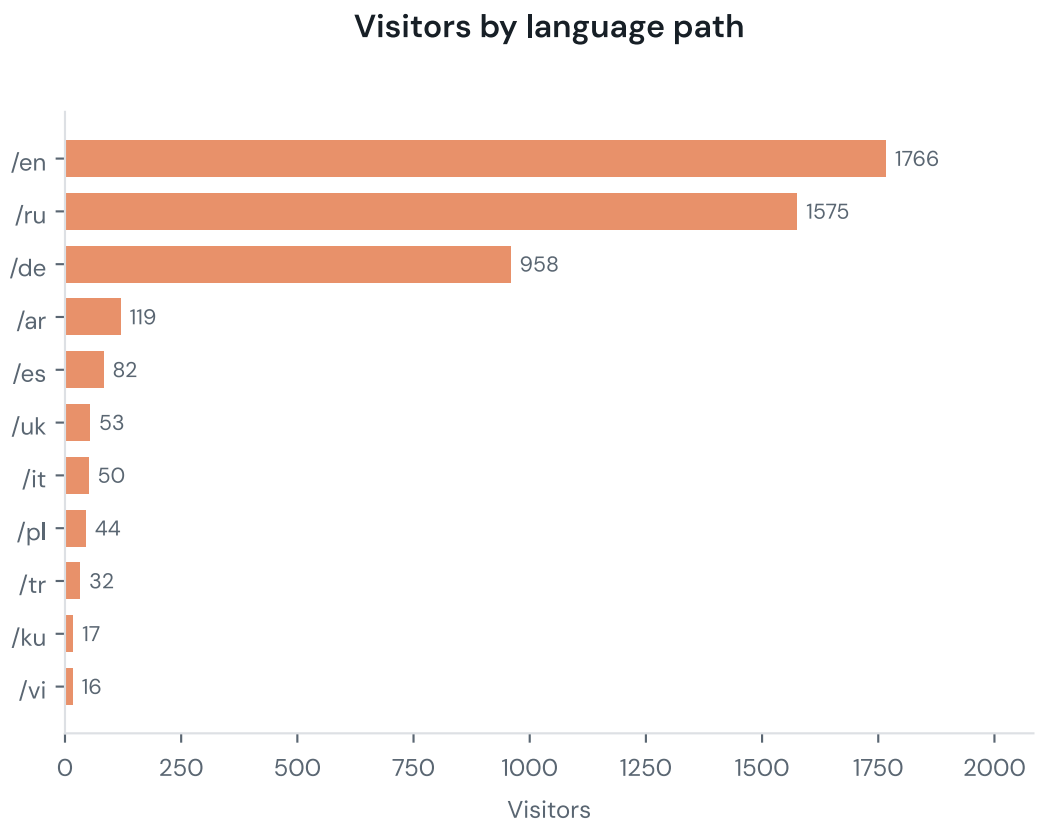
Lifetime reach (Vercel, all-period)

Source: `stats/vercel/*` (14 Jul – 14 Oct 2026).

Metric	Value
Visitors on home route template `/[lang]`	**4,255**
Pageviews on `/[lang]`	**6,076**
Mobile / desktop / tablet visitors	**2,776** / **1,519** / **22** (~64% mobile)
Top country	**DE** 3,624 visitors (US 139, NL 44, GB 42, …)
Top browsers	Mobile Safari 1,373; Chrome 991; Chrome Mobile 785

Language paths (Vercel, all-period)

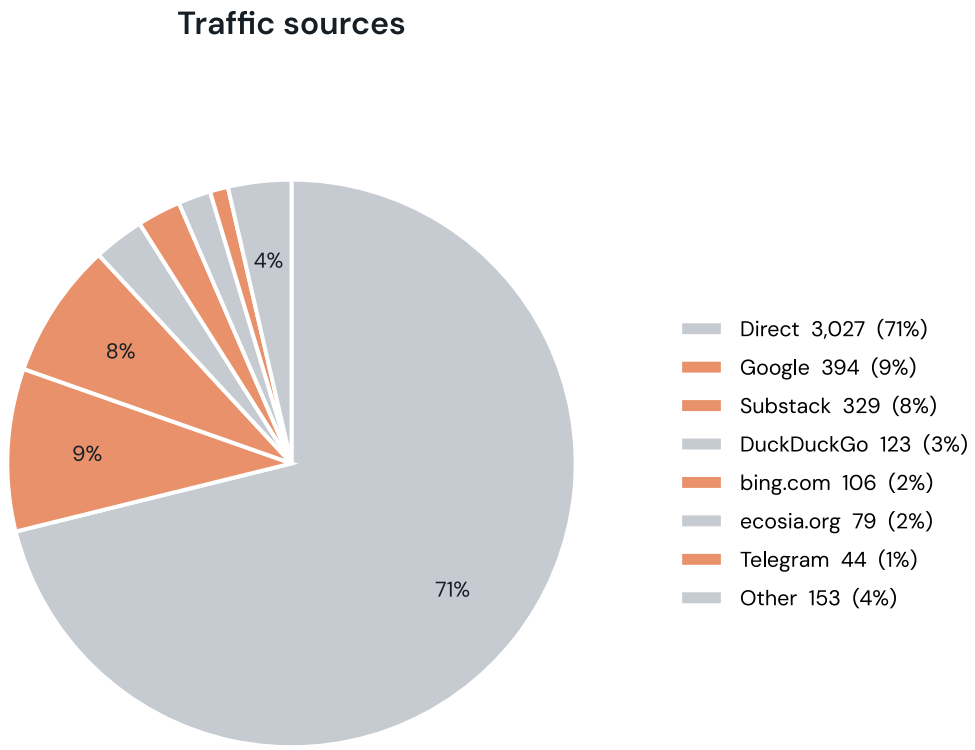
Visitors are per path (not mutually exclusive across languages). **Not** split by election end — use the PostHog language section below for before/after.



Path	Visitors	Pageviews
`/en`	1,766	2,256
`/ru`	1,575	1,997
`/de`	958	1,245
`/ar`	119	162
`/es`	82	108
`/uk`	53	77
`/it`	50	73
`/pl`	44	60
`/tr`	32	43
`/ku`	17	28
`/vi`	16	27

Traffic sources (Vercel)

Merged app/web hosts (e.g. `com.google.android.gm` → Google; Telegram app + `web.telegram.org` → Telegram). **Direct** = `/[lang]` visitors minus attributed referrers.



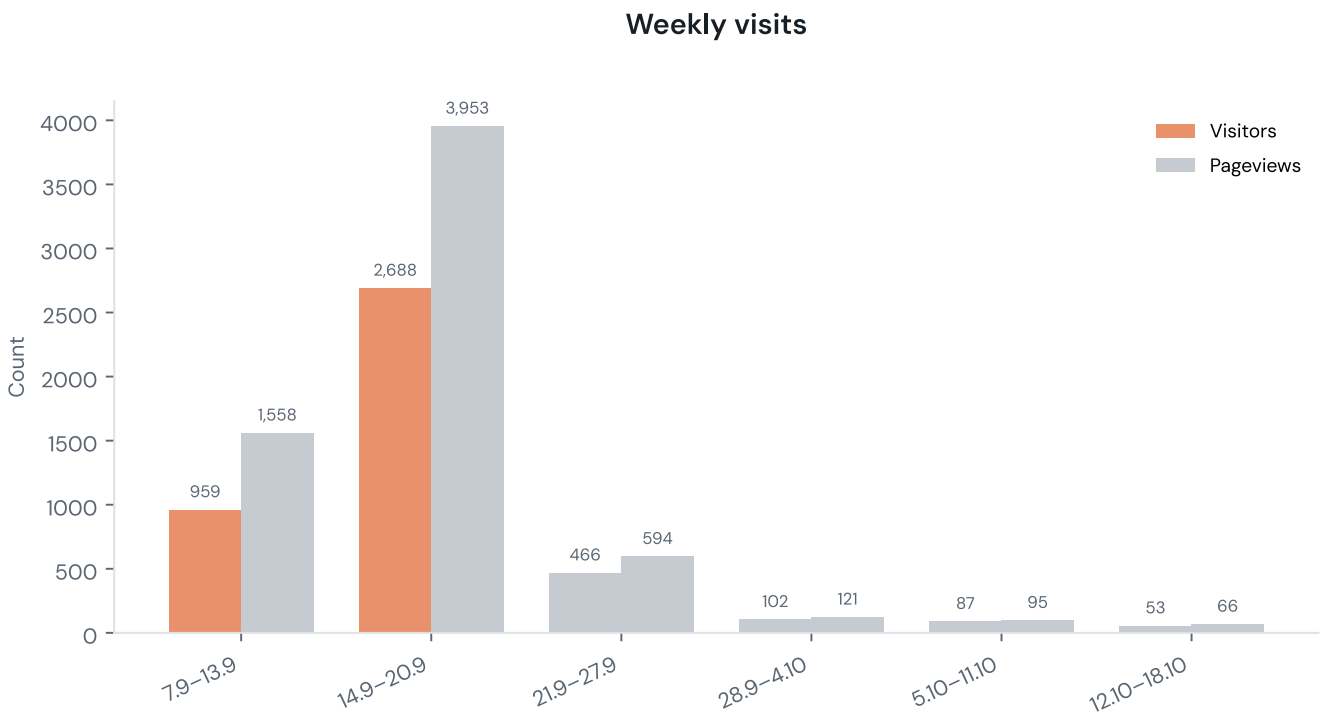
Source	Visitors	Share of `/[lang]`
Direct	3,027	71%
Google	394	9%
Substack	329	8%
DuckDuckGo	123	3%
bing.com	106	2%
ecosia.org	79	2%
Telegram	44	1%
Other (incl. Facebook, ChatGPT, …)	153	4%

Instrumented engagement (PostHog)

Source: `stats/posthog/export-2026-10-14-082324.csv` . Cutoff: **end of elections** 20 Sep 2026 18:00 Europe/Berlin.

Weekly visits (Vercel)

Source: `stats/vercel/visits-by-week.json` (Web Analytics API, `by=week`). Weeks with zero traffic before September omitted from the chart.



Week (Mon–Sun)	Visitors	Pageviews
7.9–13.9	959	1,558
14.9–20.9 (contains end of elections)	**2,688**	**3,953**
21.9–27.9	466	594
28.9–4.10	102	121
5.10–11.10	87	95
12.10–18.10	53	66

Visitor counts are **per week** (not additive unique users across weeks). Peak week is **14.9–20.9**, spanning election day / end of voting.

Time on site and time with topics (highlight)

Derived from PostHog `$session_id` (or `$device_id` fallback) and `topic_open` timestamps in the instrumented window.

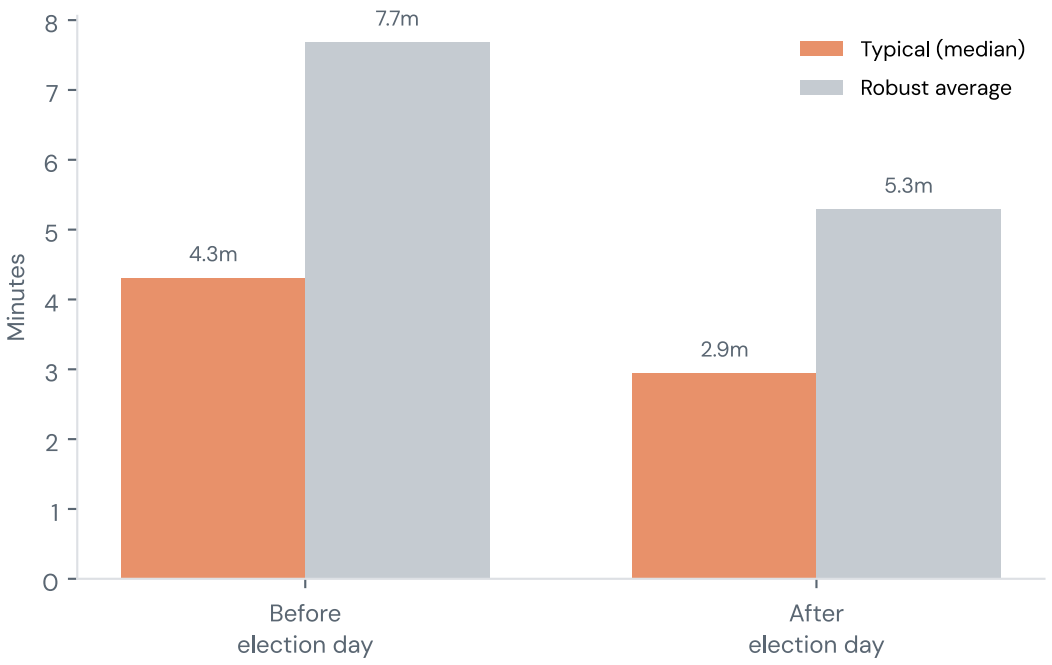
Session length is right-skewed (idle tabs pull a raw average up). We therefore report **median** (typical visit) and a **5%/5% trimmed mean** (average of the middle 90% after dropping the shortest and longest 5%). Long real reading sessions are kept; only a **4 hour** sanity bound removes impossible spans (none in this export).

Method

Metric	Definition
Time on site	Last – first event in a session with at least one product event (`topic_open` / `party_*` / `program_link`); duration **> 0** and **≤ 4 hours**
Topic reading time	Gap from one `topic_open` to the **next** `topic_open` (**excludes** last topic in a session); dwell **> 0** and **≤ 30 minutes**
How we report	**Median** + IQR; **trimmed mean 5%/5%**; share of sessions longer than 2 / 5 / 15 minutes

These remain **proxies** (no dedicated dwell timer was shipped).

Time on site (product-engaged sessions)



Window	n	**Median**	IQR (p25–p75)	**Trimmed mean 5%/5%**	Share > 2 min	Share > 5 min	Share > 15 min
All instrumented	1,168	**3m 58s**	1m 17s – 10m 56s	**7m 10s**	**67%**	44%	20%
Before end of elections	935	**4m 18s**	1m 22s – 12m 28s	**7m 41s**	**69%**	46%	22%
After end of elections	233	**2m 56s**	1m 05s – 7m 19s	**5m 17s**	**59%**	37%	13%

Time reading a topic (topic→next topic, excl. last-in-session)

Window	n	**Median**	IQR	**Trimmed mean 5%/5%**
All instrumented	6,699	**0m 28s**	0m 13s – 0m 56s	**0m 37s**
Before end of elections	5,186	**0m 32s**	0m 16s – 1m 02s	**0m 41s**
After end of elections	1,513	**0m 17s**	0m 09s – 0m 34s	**0m 24s**

Headline takeaway: among people who used the comparison, a **typical** visit before end of elections lasted about **4 minutes** (median), with a robust average around **7–8 minutes** (trimmed mean); **~70%** stayed over **2 minutes**, and a typical topic dwell was about **half a minute**.

Event counts

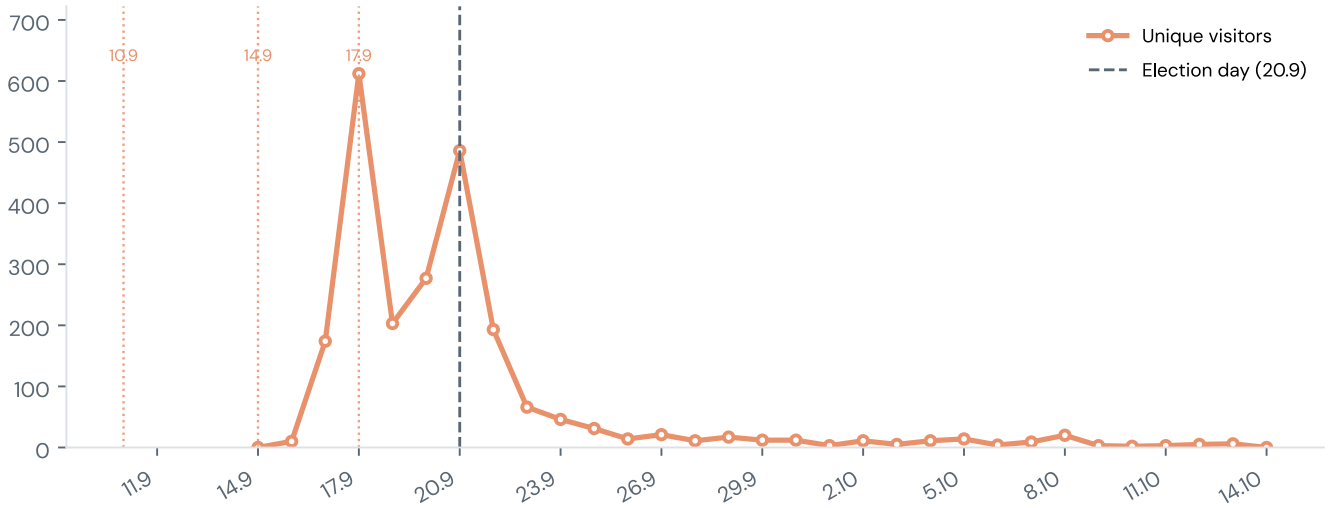
Event	Before end of elections	After end of elections	All instrumented
`$pageview`	1,985	739	2,724

`topic_open`	5,898	1,680	7,578
`party_toggle`	2,304	631	2,935
`party_preset`	183	37	220
`program_link`	164	38	202
Distinct `$device_id` (any product-related events)	1,829	814	—
Distinct `$device_id` with `$pageview`	1,628	657	—

Approx. **topic opens per pageview**: before **~3.0**; after **~2.3**.
Program / citation link-outs: before **164** (100 citation, 33 program_header, 31 program); after **38**.

Daily unique visitors

Source: `stats/posthog/web-analytics-GRAPHS.csv` (calendar days; 20 Sep is a full calendar day, not split at 18:00).

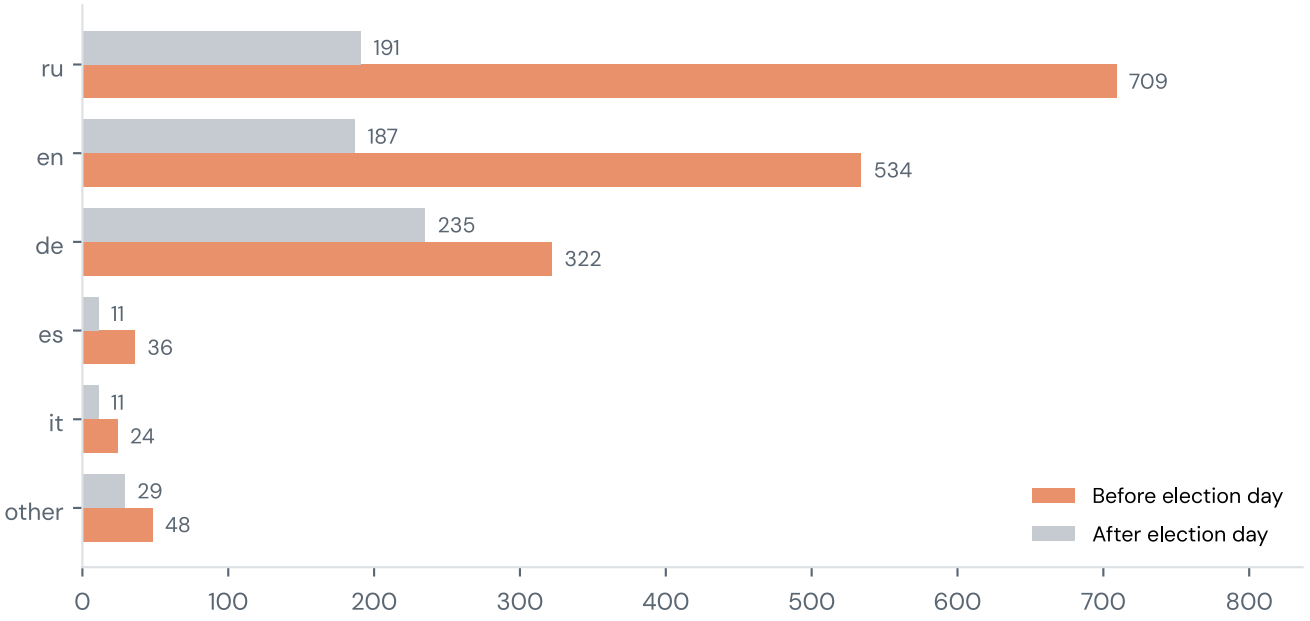


Period	Unique visitors (sum of daily uniques; not distinct across days)
15–19 Sep	1,276
20 Sep (election day)	486
21–30 Sep	423
1–13 Oct	96

Peak instrumented days: **17 Sep (612)**, **20 Sep (486)**, **19 Sep (277)**.

Visitors by language — before vs after end of elections

PostHog distinct `$device_id` on `$pageview` by `ui_language` (split at 20 Sep 18:00). Vercel paths above remain lifetime only.



Lang	Before end of elections	After end of elections
ru	709	191
en	534	187
de	322	235
es	36	11
it	24	11
ar	19	6
uk	15	3
tr	10	6
pl	2	9
vi	2	3
ku	—	2

Before end of elections: **ru / en / de** dominate. After end of elections: **de** rises relative to en/ru.

Topic groups (`topic_open`)

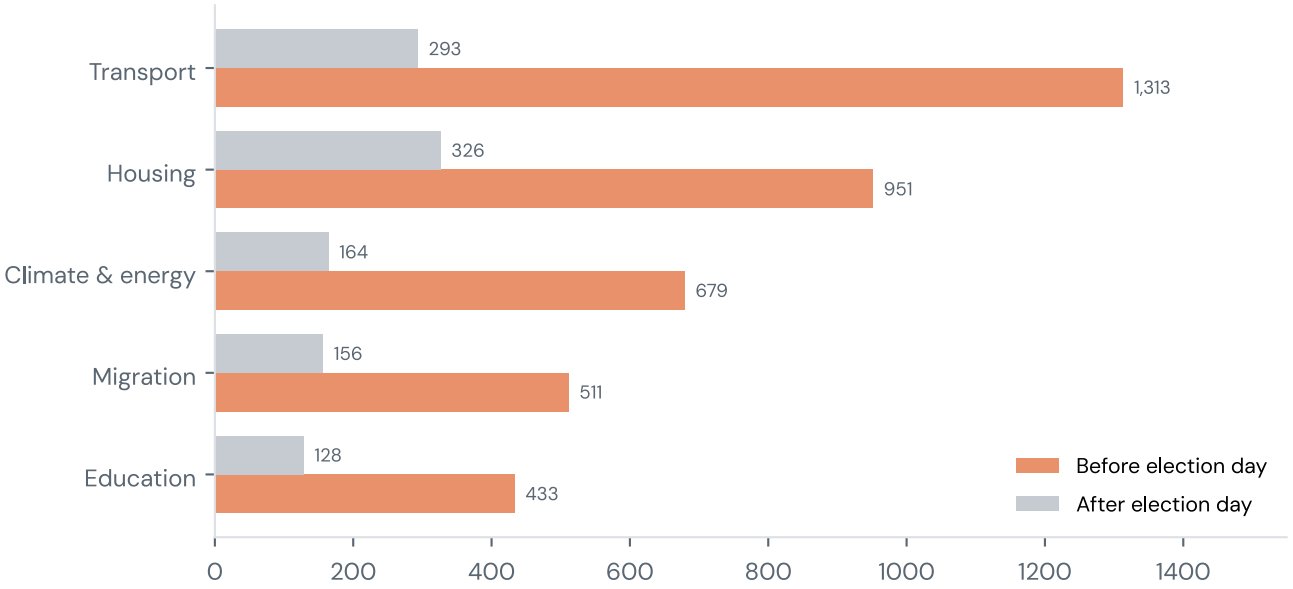


Chart shows the **top 5** groups; full counts below.

Group	Before end of elections	After end of elections
transport	1,313	293
housing	951	326
climate_energy	679	164
migration	511	156
education	433	128
democracy	390	109
security	357	138
economy	316	113
society	291	90
waste	274	66
health	266	65
animals	117	32

Top topics (before end of elections)

1. a100-construction (465)
2. migration-admission-and-deportations (250)
3. new-u-bahn-construction-line-extensions (229)
4. road-construction (221)
5. cycling-infrastructure (199)
6. housing-rent-regulation-mietendeckel (197)
7. tempelhofer-feld-development-edge-development (170)

After end of elections, top topics stay similar (A100, migration, rent, U-Bahn, Tempelhofer Feld) with housing slightly more prominent.

Party toggles (before end of elections, top)

afd 319, fdp 317, cdu 281, volt 261, linke 249, spd 233, gruene 210, bsw 204, tierschutz 123, oedp 107

(After end of elections: linke/cdu/afd/gruene/spd lead; smaller parties drop more.)

Presets

Before end of elections: `all` 119, `current_factions` 64. After end of elections: `all` 23, `current_factions` 14.

Device (PostHog `$pageview`)

Before end of elections: Mobile 1,347 / Desktop 629 / Tablet 9.
After end of elections: Mobile 439 / Desktop 298 / Tablet 2.

Search discovery (all-period)

Google Search Console

Zip: `stats/seo/google/berlin-2026.de-Performance-on-Search-2026-10-14.zip` (Web, ~3 months).

Metric	Value
Clicks (chart sum)	**275**
Impressions	**7,332**
Peak click day	**20 Sep** — 86 clicks / 1,686 impressions
Next peaks	19 Sep (53), 14 Sep (22), 21 Sep (15)

Top pages by clicks: `/en` 125, `/de` 77, `/ru` 20, `/it` 16, `/pl` 11, `/ar` 9.
Device clicks: Mobile 179, Desktop 92, Tablet 4.
Queries are sparse at click level; intent clusters around *Wahlprogramme / Vergleich / Berlin 2026* (DE/EN) plus RU/PL queries.

Google AI performance overview (`AIPerformanceOverviewStats`): citations reported as **0** in the exported range.

Bing Webmaster

Metric	Value
Clicks (daily overview sum)	**113**
Impressions	**4,069**
Notable keyword	`berlin wahl 2026 programmvergleich` — 2,159 impressions, 14 clicks
AI grounding sample	`parteien berlin` — 35 citations (21.21% citation share) in AI Search Queries report

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Publications / outreach

Canonical list: [`data/mentions.json`](data/mentions.json) + locale `mentionSummaries`. All dated **before end of elections**.

Date	Source	Kind	URL
2026-09-10	Volna / Berlin	Telegram	https://t.me/berlinwelle/2782
2026-09-11	Bundeskanzler	Telegram	https://t.me/bundeskanzlerRU/2386

2026-09-14	Berlin Events Weekly	Substack	https://open.substack.com/pub/berlinevents/p/berlin-events-guide-sep-1521-get
2026-09-14	The Berlin Life	Substack	https://theberlinlife.substack.com/p/berlin-election-2026-who-can-vote
2026-09-14	Handpicked Berlin	Newsletter	https://newsletter.handpickedberlin.com/p/211-who-you-gon-call-vote-for
2026-09-15	20 Percent Berlin	Substack	https://www.20percent.berlin/p/528-election-fever-berliners-pro
2026-09-17	Zerna Radosti	Telegram	https://t.me/zernaradosti/1413
2026-09-17	Russischsprachige Linke	Telegram	https://t.me/RussischsprachigeLinke/321
2026-09-17	Goose Expat	Telegram	https://t.me/goose_expat/2098

9 publications: 5 Telegram, 3 Substack, 1 newsletter.
Aligns with Vercel referrers (substack.com #2; Telegram app/web present; 20percent.berlin) and PostHog spike on **17 Sep** (three Telegram posts that day).

Product facts (repo)

Fact	Value
Live site	https://www.berlin-2026.de
Election	Abgeordnetenhaus Berlin, **20 Sep 2026**
Scope	**10** parties × **66** topics in **12** groups
Languages	en, de, tr, ku, vi, pl, ru, uk, ar, es, it
Positioning	Independent comparison; **not** voting advice; AI-assisted summaries with human editorial responsibility
Creators	Nina (content / programs); Masha (product / engineering)
Privacy analytics	PostHog EU, cookieless; Vercel Analytics aggregated

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Gaps / caveats

- No feedback / text-report volume in exports.
- Vercel and SEO CSVs are **not** split at end of elections (18:00).
- PostHog daily uniques are **calendar days**; election-day 486 includes both before and after 18:00.
- Cookieless mode and blocked analytics understate true use; topic-level events cover ~15 Sep onward (added when capacity allowed).
- Distinct `$device_id` is a privacy-preserving proxy, not a person count.